Finding Robotics Customers on LinkedIn & X

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A playbook for selling to industrial, warehouse and logistics robotics companies: who to find, which signals mean they are buying, and exact searches to run on LinkedIn and X.

Who to target

Aim at the person who owns the problem your product solves. At robotics companies that is usually engineering or operations leadership, not procurement. Below 50 employees, the founders buy almost everything themselves.

Company stage	Typical headcount	Who decides	Who champions it	What they care about
Seed / Series A	10–50	CEO, CTO / co-founder	Founding engineers	Speed to a working pilot, burn
Series B / C	50–300	VP Engineering, VP Ops / Manufacturing, Head of Supply Chain	Robotics, perception, controls, autonomy leads	Scaling deployments, reliability, unit cost
Scale-up / public (e.g. Locus, Symbotic, Geek+)	300+	VP / Director by function, Procurement	Staff engineers, program managers	Vendor risk, integration, security review

Map your product to the right department first:

- **Software, simulation, data or ML tools:** CTO, VP Engineering, Head of Autonomy / Perception / ML.
- **Components (motors, sensors, compute, batteries, grippers):** Hardware Engineering, Mechanical / Electrical leads, Supply Chain and Sourcing.

- **Field service, deployment or integration:** VP Customer Success, Deployment / Field Operations, Solutions Engineering.
- **Manufacturing or contract services:** VP Manufacturing, Head of Operations, NPI Manager.
- **GTM services (marketing, sales, recruiting):** CEO, CRO / VP Sales, VP Marketing, Head of Talent.

Buying signals

Reach out within 2–4 weeks of a trigger event. A fresh funding round, a new exec or a job post for the problem you solve is a better reason to message than a cold list. Warehouse robotics money is concentrated in a few large rounds: 2026 deals reported include Mytra ($120M Series C), Sereact ($110M Series B) and Ultra Robotics ($50M Series A) (RoboticsBiz, NewMarketPitch). Totals for the year disagree by source, from about $336M to $2.26B, so use the named deals, not the totals.

Signal	Why it means buying	Where to see it first	How to catch it
Funding round announced	New budget, hiring and tooling decisions in the next 1–2 quarters	Founder / CEO post on LinkedIn and X; The Robot Report; Crunchbase	Follow investors and founders; Google Alert "robotics" + "raises"
New VP or Head hired	New leaders re-pick vendors in their first 90 days	Sales Navigator "Changed jobs" spotlight	Saved lead search with job-change alerts
Job posts naming your category	They are building or buying what you sell now	LinkedIn Jobs, company careers page	Saved job search, e.g. "robotics" + your tool or skill
Headcount growth 10%+ in 6 months	Scaling pain: deployment, support, manufacturing	Sales Navigator account filter	Account list sorted by growth
New customer, pilot or site launch	Deployments expose field-service, data and reliability gaps	Company page posts; X launch threads	Follow company pages; X list of robotics companies

Signal	Why it means buying	Where to see it first	How to catch it
Trade show exhibitor	GTM budget and a booth team to meet	Exhibitor lists for ProMat (Apr 19–21, 2027, Chicago) and Automate (May 10–13, 2027, Las Vegas)	Book meetings 4–6 weeks ahead
Public complaint or question	Open pain, stated in their own words	X and LinkedIn posts by engineers	Keyword searches (X playbook below)

Show dates are from ProMat 2027 (MMH) and the Automate exhibit page; confirm on the organizer sites before booking.

LinkedIn playbook

Build an account list first, then find people inside it, then narrow with Spotlights. Boolean (AND, OR, NOT, quotes, brackets) works in the Keyword, Title and Company fields. It does not work in Industry, Function or Seniority, which are dropdowns (Kondo, Dropcontact). Sales Navigator Core costs about $100 a month and caps each search at 2,500 results (DEV), so keep each search narrow.

Step 1: account search (companies)

1. Industry: Robotics Engineering, Automation Machinery Manufacturing, Industrial Machinery Manufacturing, Warehousing and Storage (for in-house teams).
2. Company headcount: 11–50, 51–200, 201–500 (one saved search per band).
3. Headcount growth: 10%+ over 6 months.
4. Keyword: `("autonomous mobile robot" OR AMR OR AGV OR "warehouse robotics" OR "robotic picking" OR cobot OR "mobile manipulation" OR "robotic arm") NOT (recruiting OR staffing OR university)`
5. Save it as an account list; turn on alerts for funding, hiring and exec moves.

Step 2: lead search inside that list

- Engineering: `(CTO OR "VP Engineering" OR "Head of Engineering" OR "Director of Engineering" OR "Head of Autonomy" OR "Head of Perception" OR "Head of Robotics")`

- Hardware and supply chain: `("Hardware Engineering" OR "Mechanical Engineering" OR "Supply Chain" OR Sourcing OR Procurement) AND (Director OR Head OR VP OR Manager)`
- Deployment and ops: `("Field Operations" OR Deployment OR "Customer Success" OR "Solutions Engineering" OR Manufacturing OR NPI) AND (Director OR Head OR VP)`
- Founders at small companies: Title `(founder OR co-founder OR CEO)` + headcount 11–50.
- Add to every title string: `NOT (intern OR student OR recruiter OR consultant OR assistant)`.

Step 3: Spotlights (who to message first)

- Changed jobs in the past 90 days
- Posted on LinkedIn in the past 30 days
- Mentioned in the news
- Following your company, or has a TeamLink connection to a colleague

Sources disagree on these windows and where each filter sits, so check your own Sales Navigator (Expandi, SMARTe).

No Sales Navigator? Use the free search with Boolean in the main search bar and the Title field, e.g. `"warehouse robotics" AND (CTO OR "VP Engineering")`. Then filter by People, Current company and Location.

Content and groups

- Search posts (sorted by Latest): `"AMR" AND (deployment OR pilot OR "go-live")`, `"we're hiring" AND robotics AND (perception OR controls)`, `robotics AND (raised OR "Series A" OR "Series B")`.
- Follow people and companies who post often: A3 (Association for Advancing Automation), MHI, The Robot Report, and founders of your top 50 accounts. Comment usefully before you connect.
- Join A3 and robotics groups, and attendee groups for ProMat and Automate, but expect low activity. Use group members as a search pool, not a place to pitch.

X playbook

X is where robotics founders and engineers post launches, demos, hiring and frustrations in real time. Use it to spot timing and open conversations; LinkedIn is still where you find the org chart. Paste these into x.com/search, sort by Latest, and save each one. Operators come from third-party guides, not X's own docs, so test them before relying on them (Circleboom, SocialRails).

Goal	Search to paste
Funding news	`(warehouse OR AMR OR "mobile robot" OR cobot OR "robotic picking") (raised OR "Series A" OR "Series B" OR "seed round") -filter:replies lang:en`
Launches and deployments	`(AMR OR "warehouse robot" OR "robot fleet") (deployed OR "go-live" OR pilot OR "first customer") min_faves:10`
Hiring (a budget signal)	`robotics (hiring OR "we're hiring" OR "join us") (perception OR controls OR "field engineer" OR deployment) -filter:replies`
Pain you can solve	`(robot OR robotics OR AMR) ("anyone know" OR "looking for" OR recommend OR "struggling with") (simulation OR teleop OR sensor OR "fleet management")`
Your competitors' users	`(@CompetitorHandle OR "Competitor Name") (issue OR switching OR alternative OR down)`
Event chatter	`(#ProMat OR #ProMat2027 OR #Automate2027 OR "Automate show") (booth OR demo OR "come see")`

Swap in your own category words for simulation, teleop and sensor. Add `since:YYYY-MM-DD` to see only new posts.

Lists to build (private)

1. *Target founders and CTOs*: the decision makers from your LinkedIn list who are active on X. Check daily and reply to them.

2. *Robotics companies*: the official accounts of your top 50–100 accounts, for launches and funding.
3. *Robotics media and investors*: The Robot Report, A3, MHI and robotics-focused VCs. Their posts surface new companies before they reach databases.

Find more targets from a seed account. Open a known target's Following list. Robotics founders follow peers, investors and suppliers, so add the relevant ones to your lists. A search such as `"robotics" (founder OR CTO)` on the People tab also works.

Hashtags are weak on X; keywords work better. Still worth watching: #robotics, #warehouseautomation, #AMR, #cobots, #logistics, plus event tags.

Outreach

Engage before you pitch: two or three useful interactions make the connection request familiar instead of cold. Tie every message to the trigger you saw.

1. **Day 0:** follow them on LinkedIn and X; like or comment with substance on one recent post (a question, a data point, a related experience).
2. **Day 2–3:** send a connection request with a short note, or no note if you have already interacted.
3. **Day 1 after accepting:** first message, with the trigger, one relevant proof point and a low-effort ask.
4. **Day 5–7:** follow up with something useful: a short teardown, benchmark, or a customer story from a similar robotics company.
5. **Day 12–14:** last nudge on a different channel (X reply or DM, or email via enrichment), then stop.

Connection note (under 300 characters)

> Hi {first name}, saw {company}'s {raise / new site / launch of X}. I work with {similar robotics companies} on {the problem}. Would be good to connect.

First message after accepting

> Thanks for connecting, {first name}. Congrats on {trigger}. Teams scaling AMR fleets past {N} sites usually hit {specific pain, e.g. field-service backlog or sim-to-real gaps}. We helped {peer company} {result with a number}. Worth a 15-minute look at how they did it?

Value follow-up

> {first name}, put together a one-page breakdown of how {2–3 peer robotics companies} handle {problem}. Happy to send it over, no call needed.

X reply (public, to a founder's post)

> Add a specific, useful point to their thread. No link and no pitch. DM only after they reply or follow back.

What works with engineers: name the robot type and the job (AMR picking, palletizing, mobile manipulation), use real numbers, and skip buzzwords. Proof from a peer company beats any feature list.

Tools and limits

Stay under about 100 connection requests per rolling 7 days. LinkedIn does not publish its limit; vendor guides put it at 100–200, and Premium or Sales Navigator does not raise it (Taplio, Salesforge, Reachally). InMails do not count toward that cap.

Job	Tools	Note
Find accounts and people	LinkedIn Sales Navigator; Crunchbase or Growth List for funded robotics startups (Growth List, VCBacked)	Sales Navigator is the core; databases fill gaps
Emails and phone numbers	Apollo, ZoomInfo, Lusha (all connectable to Claude)	Use for the off-LinkedIn follow-up step
Signal alerts	Sales Navigator alerts, Google Alerts, The Robot Report newsletter, saved X searches	Check daily, act within days
Track the pipeline	Your CRM (e.g. HubSpot)	Log the trigger with each lead

Rules to stay within

- LinkedIn's User Agreement bans scrapers and bots. Browser automation tools (connection or message sequencers) risk restriction. If you use one, run only one tool at a time and never restart it right after hitting a limit (La Growth Machine).
- A soft lock usually lifts in 3–7 days. Stop all automation for at least a week, then resume manually.
- X restricts bulk or automated replies and unsolicited DMs. Keep X engagement manual and personal.
- Most limit figures here come from vendors that sell automation, so treat them as estimates.

Weekly routine and metrics

About 45 minutes a day is enough to run this for 50–100 target accounts.

When	What	Time
Daily	Check Sales Navigator alerts and saved X searches; note new triggers	15 min
Daily	Comment on 5–10 posts from target leads (LinkedIn and X lists)	15 min
Daily	Send 10–15 connection requests and reply to accepts	15 min
Weekly (Mon)	Add 20–30 new accounts from funding news and growth filters	30 min
Weekly (Fri)	Review metrics; rewrite the weakest message	20 min

Track these each week

- Connection acceptance rate (low means the targeting or the note is off)
- Reply rate to the first message
- Meetings booked, and which trigger each came from
- Accounts touched vs. your target list

Open question: no reliable public benchmarks exist for robotics-specific acceptance or reply rates. Set your own baseline over the first 4 weeks.

Sources

These came from web search results. The pages could not be opened from this session, so check figures (funding amounts, limits, filter windows, show dates) before relying on them.

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- Growth List: funded robotics startups
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- Reachally: LinkedIn connection limits 2026
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- MMH: dates set for ProMat 2027
- Automate 2027 exhibit page